JavaScript is disabled on your browser.

Annotation Interface Documented

```
@Documented
@Retention(RUNTIME)
@Target(ANNOTATION_TYPE)
public @interface Documented
```

If the annotation `@Documented` is present on the declaration of an annotation interface *A*, then any `@A` annotation on an element is considered part of the element's public contract. In more detail, when an annotation interface *A* is annotated with `Documented`, the presence and value of *A* annotations are a part of the public contract of the elements *A* annotates. Conversely, if an annotation interface *B* is *not* annotated with `Documented`, the presence and value of *B* annotations are *not* part of the public contract of the elements *B* annotates. Concretely, if an annotation interface is annotated with `Documented`, by default a tool like javadoc will display annotations of that interface in its output while annotations of annotation interfaces without `Documented` will not be displayed.

Since:

1.5

Report a bug or suggest an enhancement
For further API reference and developer documentation see the Java SE Documentation, which contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples. Other versions.
Java is a trademark or registered trademark of Oracle and/or its affiliates in the US and other countries.
Copyright © 1993, 2026, Oracle and/or its affiliates, 500 Oracle Parkway, Redwood Shores, CA 94065 USA.
All rights reserved. Use is subject to license terms and the documentation redistribution policy.

Scripting on this page tracks web page traffic, but does not change the content in any way.